JAMES CHRISTOPHER MITCHELL

Principal Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a Principal Engineer with seven years of experience building scalable infrastructure and leading technical teams across fintech and SaaS environments. I've spent the last three years at senior levels designing distributed systems that handle millions of transactions daily while mentoring engineers and shaping architectural decisions. I thrive in fast-paced settings where I can solve complex problems and help others grow their technical capabilities.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Principal Engineer

Vortex Technologies Ltd

vortextechnologies.io

Liverpool, United Kingdom

March 2022 - Present

Led the design and implementation of a microservices migration project that reduced system latency by 40 percent across 12 core services serving 2 million daily active users. Mentored a team of 5 engineers through code reviews, architectural discussions, and career development conversations that resulted in two promotions within 18 months. Established standardised observability practices using Prometheus and Grafana, reducing mean time to detection for production incidents from 45 minutes to 8 minutes. Collaborated with product leadership to define technical roadmap priorities, balancing infrastructure improvements with feature delivery across four product quarters.

Senior Software Engineer

Bridgepoint Financial Services

www.bridgepointfs.com

Manchester, United Kingdom

June 2020 - February 2022

Built and maintained payment processing systems handling £2.3 billion in annual transaction volume with 99.98 percent uptime across high availability Kubernetes clusters. Implemented comprehensive API rate limiting and authentication systems that prevented security incidents and reduced fraudulent transaction attempts by 35 percent. Designed database sharding strategy that improved query performance by 60 percent and enabled horizontal scaling to support 300 percent growth in data volume. Led incident response procedures and conducted blameless post-mortems that drove adoption of new monitoring and alerting standards across engineering teams.

Software Engineer

Catalyst Digital Solutions

catalystdigital.net

Liverpool, United Kingdom

August 2017 - May 2020

Developed backend services in Python and Go that powered document processing and workflow automation for enterprise clients across legal and financial sectors. Contributed to infrastructure-as-code initiatives using Terraform, reducing environment provisioning time from 6 hours to 15 minutes and improving consistency across staging and production deployments. Implemented comprehensive test suites achieving 82 percent code coverage

and established CI/CD pipelines using Jenkins that automated testing, building, and deployment processes. Participated in on-call rotations and resolved critical production incidents affecting customer operations, with average resolution time of 22 minutes.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

University of Manchester

Manchester, United Kingdom

Graduated: June 2017

SKILLS

Languages: Python, Go, Java, SQL, Bash

Cloud Platforms: AWS, Google Cloud Platform, Azure

Containerisation and Orchestration: Docker, Kubernetes, Docker Compose

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis, Elasticsearch

Infrastructure: Terraform, CloudFormation, Ansible

Monitoring and Observability: Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack, Datadog

Message Queues: RabbitMQ, Apache Kafka

CI/CD: Jenkins, GitLab CI, GitHub Actions

Version Control: Git

Architecture Patterns: Microservices, Event-Driven Architecture, CQRS